

Communication

Character **First****GOALS MONTH 4**

- You can apply the I-Message model in a real situation from your sports life
- You give constructive feedback to a teammate without triggering blame or defensiveness
- You plan and have at least one difficult conversation you have been postponing

How you speak determines how you work together. You learn the difference between reacting and truly communicating, and how to give feedback without damaging relationships.

EXERCISE 1 — I-MESSAGE**1 The I-Message**

The model: "I see... I feel... I need... I ask you to..." Write a situation from your sports life using this model.

I SEE...**I FEEL...****I NEED...****I ASK YOU TO...****EXERCISE 2 — DIFFICULT CONVERSATION****2 The Conversation I Keep Postponing**

Write a conversation you have wanted to have for a long time but keep postponing. With a coach, teammate, or parent.

Who is this conversation with?

Why do I keep postponing it?

Write the first sentence to open the conversation (use the I-Message):

When will I plan this conversation? (date + place)

EXERCISE 3 — FEEDBACK ROUND REFLECTION**3 After the Feedback Round**

What was the best feedback you received? What will you concretely do with it?

"Communication is the most important skill any leader can possess."

